

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 3 2
♥ A 8 7 3
♦ 9 7 4
♣ J 10 2

♠ K Q J 5

♥ K 10

♦ A 8 3

♣ A 9 6 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 10 8 4

♥ 6 5 2

♦ K Q J 10 5

♣ K 8

♠ A 7 6

♥ Q J 9 4

♦ 6 2

♣ Q 7 5 3

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by North			
Lead: ♦ K			

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♦ K, dummy plays the ♦ 2 and West the ♦ 4.

Winners: ♠=4 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=1 Total = 6

You need 3 more winners, and they must come from the ♥ suit. The danger is that when you knock out the ♥ A, East may take too many ♦ s.

East continues with the ♦ Q; dummy plays the ♦ 6 and West the ♦ 7.

East continues with the ♦ J; dummy discards the ♣ 3 and West plays the ♦ 9.

You held up your ♦ A until the third round to exhaust West of ♦ s.

Next you start on ♥ s by playing ♥ K, then overtaking the ♥ 10. Assume that West wins the second ♥ .

You were fortunate it was West who took the ♥ A, and that he has no ♦ to return. If he plays a ♥ or a ♠ you will win in dummy. If he plays a ♣ you will jump up with the ♣ A and take your winners, 9 in all.

You were lucky the ♥ A was with West.

But if you had not held-up your ♦ A even good luck wouldn't have helped you.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 7 6
 ♥ A 8 6 5 3
 ♦ K 5
 ♣ A K 5

♠ 9 4 3
 ♥ Q 9 7 2
 ♦ A 8 4
 ♣ Q 10 2



♠ 8 2
 ♥ K 4
 ♦ Q J 10 7 3
 ♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ K Q J 10 5
 ♥ J 10
 ♦ 9 6 2
 ♣ J 7 6

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Pass	1NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♠ K			

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠ K.

North follows with the ♠ 3 and you play the ♠ 2.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=0 ♣=2 Total = 5

Even if ♥s split 3-3 you could only get 2 extra winners there, so it should be clear that you must establish the ♦s. You will have to drive out the ♦ A and hope they don't win too many ♠s at that time.

South continues with the ♠ Q.

North follows with the ♠ 4 and you play the ♠ 8.
South continues with the ♠ J.

North follows with the ♠ 9 and you discard the ♣ 3.
Holding up the ♠ A until the third round helps your chances.

Having just taken the third ♠ trick you now work on ♦s by first playing the ♦ K, then continuing the suit. North wins the third one with his ♦ A. And now the good news - he has no ♠ left to reach his partner's good tricks. So North plays the ♥ Q.

At this point in the play you have three tricks in the bank; ♠ A, ♦ K, ♦ Q. You take your ♥ K, cash the two good ♦s, then lead to dummy for the ♣ A K and ♥ A. Voila!

You were lucky that North had the ♦ A since he only had 3 ♠s.

But what if North actually held 4 ♠s? No problem, in that case the ♠s would have split 4-4 so the defenders could only win 3 ♠ tricks and the ♦ A.

The hold-up lets you make the contract whenever North holds the ♦ A. And if South happened to hold the ♦ A??? You go down.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 7 3 2

♥ 10 7

♦ 6 5

♣ J 10 8 2

♠ 10 5

♥ K 8 5 4

♦ A 10 9 3

♣ K 6 5



♠ K 9 4

♥ A 6 3

♦ Q J 8 2

♣ A Q 4

♠ A 8 6

♥ Q J 9 2

♦ K 7 4

♣ 9 7 3

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♠3			

♦K.

It's too bad the finesse didn't work, but it's not too too bad! Because East is out of ♠s and must lead one of the other suits. You don't care which he leads because you can now win 8 more tricks and make your contract.

As long as you were going to finesse into East you could establish the ♦s without allowing West to gain the lead.

And as long as you had held up on the ♠K until the third round you could ensure that East was out of ♠s if he had started with only 3.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠3. East wins the first trick with the ♠A and returns the ♠8.

West plays the ♠Q and dummy the ♠10.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 7

You can win 3 more ♦ tricks if the finesse works, but even if it doesn't work you can still get the 2 that you need. Of course if East does win the ♦K it would sure be great if he had no ♠ to lead.

West continues with the ♠J; dummy discards a ♥ and East plays the ♠6.

You ducked the second ♠ and took your ♠K on the third round.

After winning the ♠K you are conveniently in your hand, so you play the ♦Q and let it ride when West plays a low card. Alas, East takes the trick with his

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K 7 5
 ♥ K J 7
 ♦ A 8 3
 ♣ 9 8 2

♠ 10 8 4
 ♥ 6 5 4 2
 ♦ K Q J 4
 ♣ 7 5



♠ Q 6
 ♥ A 10 9
 ♦ 7 5 2
 ♣ K J 10 6 4

♠ J 9 3 2
 ♥ Q 8 3
 ♦ 10 9 6
 ♣ A Q 3

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by West			
Lead: ♦ K			

West is to play 3NT. North leads the ♦ K, dummy plays the ♦ 2 and South the ♦ 6.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 6

You will need some ♣ tricks to make the contract. If North has 5 ♦ s and also the ♣ A then you will go down. It doesn't matter if he has the ♣ Q because you can finesse him out of that.

But in the case where South has both the ♣ A Q you need to make sure he has no ♦ when he takes his first trick.

North continues with the ♦ Q; dummy plays the ♦ 5 and South the ♦ 9.

North continues with the ♦ J; dummy plays the ♦ 7 and South the ♦ 10.

You held up the ♦ A until the third round, everybody following.

Now start on the ♣ s. Play your ♣ 9 and let it ride. South wins the ♣ Q and returns a ♠ . Good, he didn't have the fourth ♦ .

Win with dummy's ♠ Q and force out the ♣ A.

The rest of the tricks are yours, nine in all.

If South had only held 2 ♦ s it would have been OK to hold up your ♦ A just once.

But with this layout you needed to hold up twice.